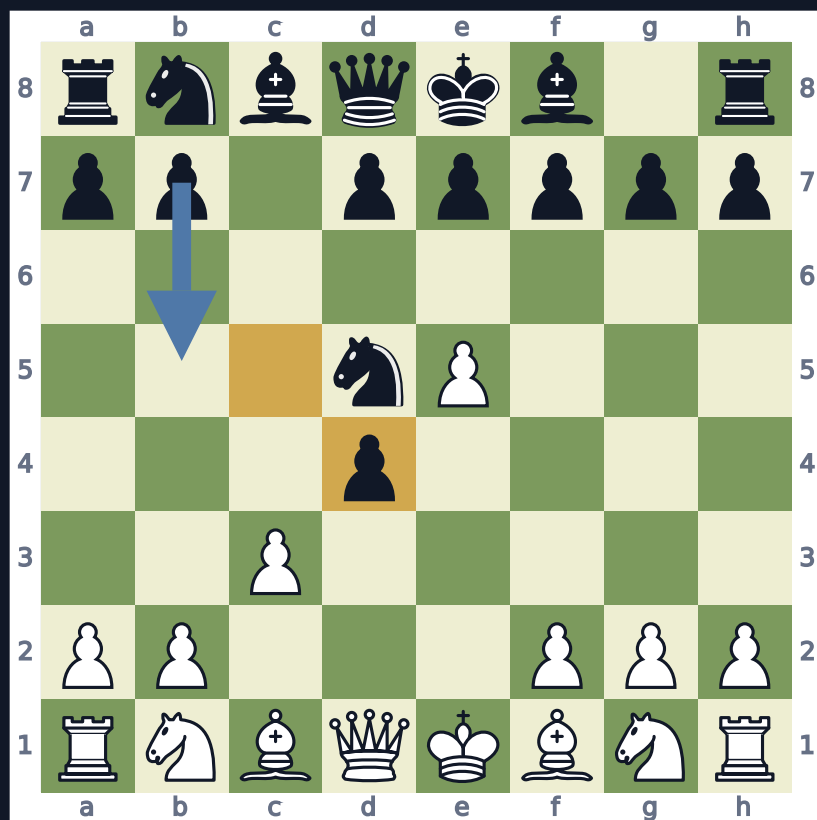


11

The Alapin 2.c3

A direct d4 center, isolated-queen-pawn transitions, and active counterplay with ...Nf6 or ...d5.



THIS VOLUME

6

deep lessons

12

lesson positions

30

course pages

You will deny White a comfortable center and understand the middlegames that replace normal Open Sicilian play.

LEARN THE STRUCTURE, THEN THE LINE

A four-pass method for a theory-heavy opening

1. DECODE THE POSITION

Read the board before the moves. Name the center, each side's break, the worst piece, the king-safety difference, and the race clock.

2. UNDERSTAND THE CAUSAL CHAIN

Every recommendation connects a cue to a reason and a consequence. If you know only the move, you do not yet know the opening.

3. PLAY THE DECISION

Generate Black's candidates, find White's strongest reply, and choose the resulting structure you understand. The move is the end of the reasoning, not the beginning.

4. RETRIEVE UNDER PRESSURE

Cover the answer key, reconstruct the line, and speak the memory rule. Review after 1, 3, 7, 14, and 30 days, then test the idea in a slow game.

THEORY WARNING

This is a durable concept-first repertoire, not a claim to be a live engine database. Before tournament use, verify sharp forcing branches in Fritz or a current database.

Priority order at the board: legality and tactical survival, king safety, forcing moves, central transformation, activity, structure, then the remembered rule.

SIX LINKED LESSONS

Recognition first, execution second

LESSON 061 | PAGE 4

Decode: 2...Nf6 attacks e4*When White builds a center, attack its front and base while developing.*

LESSON 062 | PAGE 8

Play: 2...Nf6 attacks e4*When White builds a center, attack its front and base while developing.*

LESSON 063 | PAGE 12

Decode: 2...d5 immediate equality test*The central break works when the queen's recapture has a stable square.*

LESSON 064 | PAGE 16

Play: 2...d5 immediate equality test*The central break works when the queen's recapture has a stable square.*

LESSON 065 | PAGE 20

Decode: Isolated d-pawn transition*First stop the pawn's break; only then collect the weakness.*

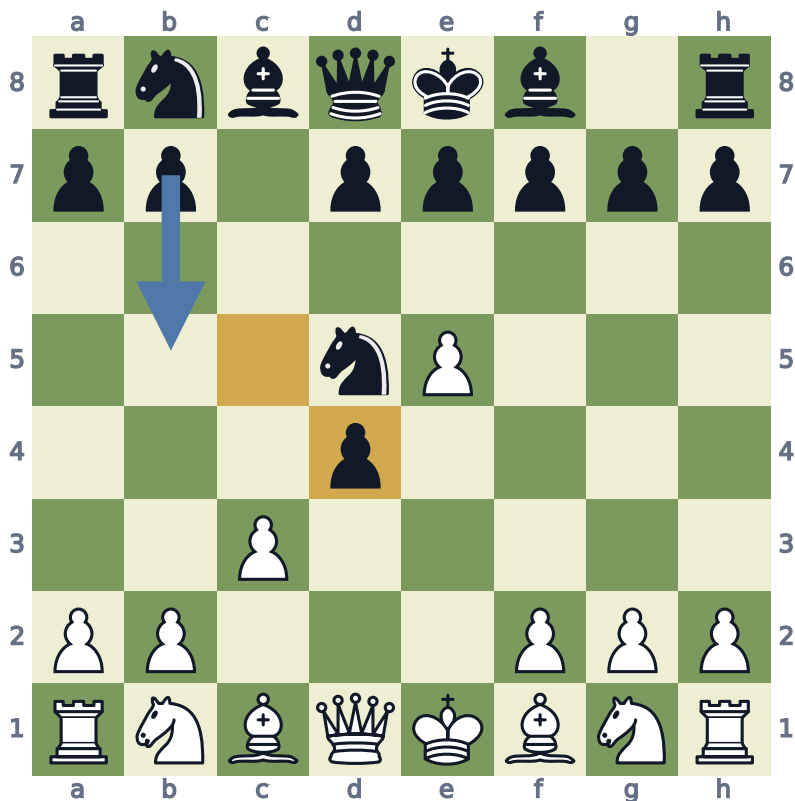
LESSON 066 | PAGE 24

Play: Isolated d-pawn transition*First stop the pawn's break; only then collect the weakness.***VOLUME OBJECTIVE**

You will deny White a comfortable center and understand the middlegames that replace normal Open Sicilian play.

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: 2...Nf6 attacks e4



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Black attacks e4 before White builds d4, forcing e5 and gaining targets on d4 and the advanced pawn chain.

DECISION RULE

Can Black attack the pawn chain without allowing a tactic on the exposed d5 knight?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Pressure e5 and d4, develop with tempo, and use ...d6 to undermine the chain.

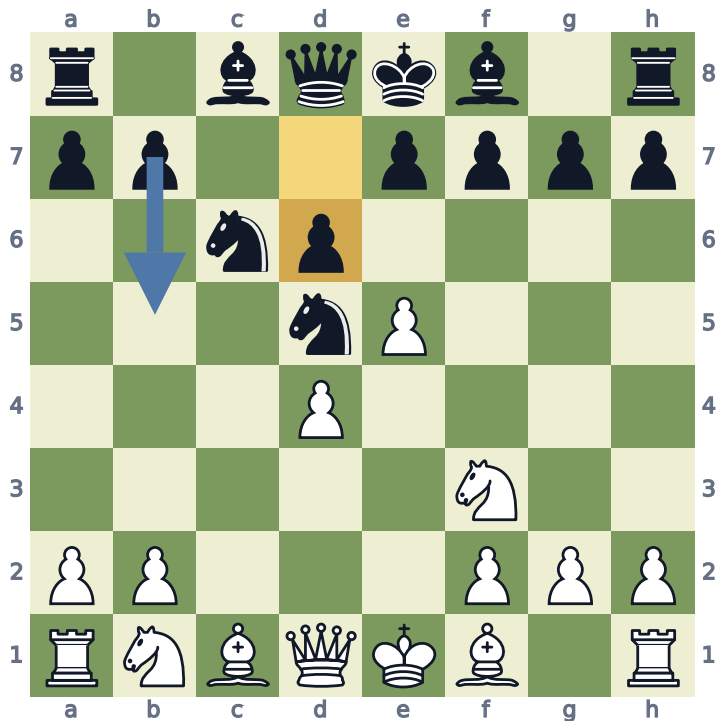
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White supports the broad center and uses development to keep the advanced e-pawn safe.

MEMORY RULE | When White builds a center, attack its front and base while developing.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Black attacks e4 before White builds d4, forcing e5 and gaining targets on d4 and the advanced pawn chain.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Pressure e5 and d4, develop with tempo, and use ...d6 to undermine the chain.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White supports the broad center and uses development to keep the advanced e-pawn safe.

FAILURE MODE

Moving the knight repeatedly without completing development or challenging the center.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Can Black attack the pawn chain without allowing a tactic on the exposed d5 knight? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

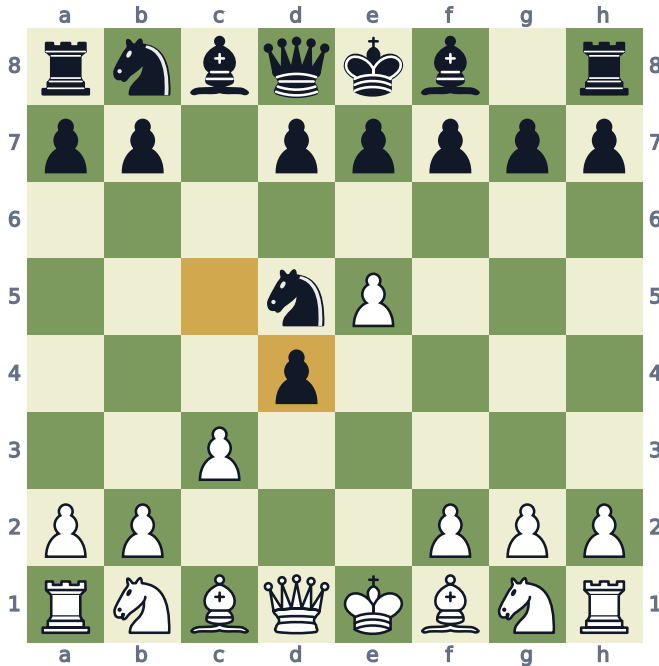
RULE | When White builds a center, attack its front and base while developing.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. c3 Nf6 3. e5 Nd5 4. d4 cxd4 5. Nf3 Nc6 6. cxd4 d6



- c3: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- e5: White changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Nd5: Black reroutes a knight to d5; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- d4: White builds the Open Sicilian center and offers the d-pawn for rapid development.
- cxd4: Black releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Black attacks e4 before White builds d4, forcing e5 and gaining targets on d4 and the advanced pawn chain.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Can Black attack the pawn chain without allowing a tactic on the exposed d5 knight? White's resistance is: White supports the broad center and uses development to keep the advanced e-pawn safe. The line fails as a template when: Moving the knight repeatedly without completing development or challenging the center.

STORE THIS | When White builds a center, attack its front and base while developing.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

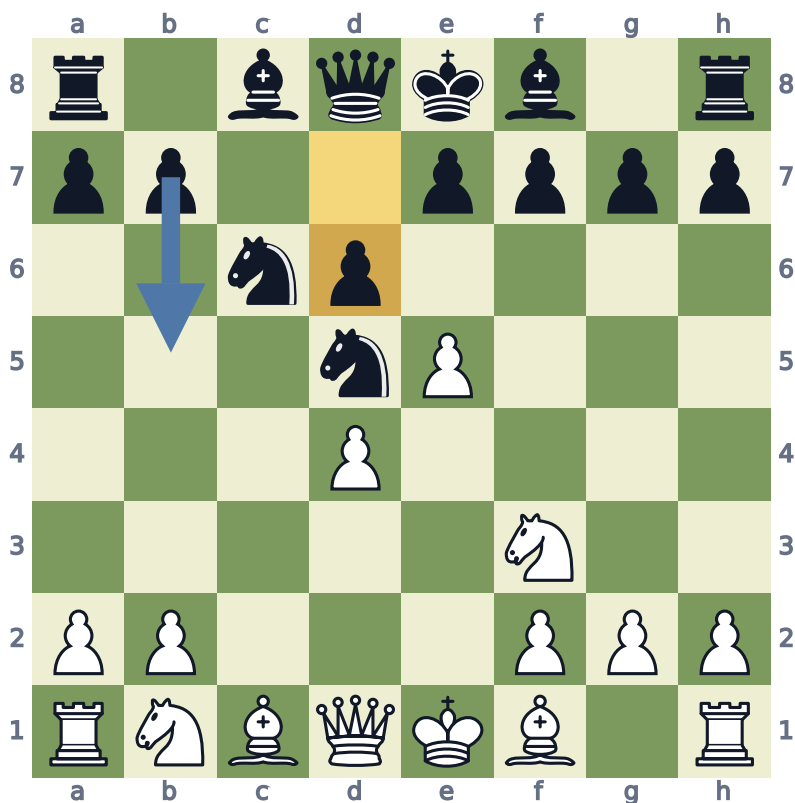
1. Black attacks e4 before White builds d4, forcing e5 and gaining targets on d4 and the advanced pawn chain. 2. Pressure e5 and d4, develop with tempo, and use ...d6 to undermine the chain. 3. White supports the broad center and uses development to keep the advanced e-pawn safe. 4. Can Black attack the pawn chain without allowing a tactic on the exposed d5 knight? 5. Moving the knight repeatedly without completing development or challenging the center.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 8 plies from memory, then replay: 2. c3 Nf6 3. e5 Nd5 4. d4 cxd4

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: 2...Nf6 attacks e4



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

Black attacks e4 before White builds d4, forcing e5 and gaining targets on d4 and the advanced pawn chain.

DECISION RULE

Can Black attack the pawn chain without allowing a tactic on the exposed d5 knight?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Pressure e5 and d4, develop with tempo, and use ...d6 to undermine the chain.

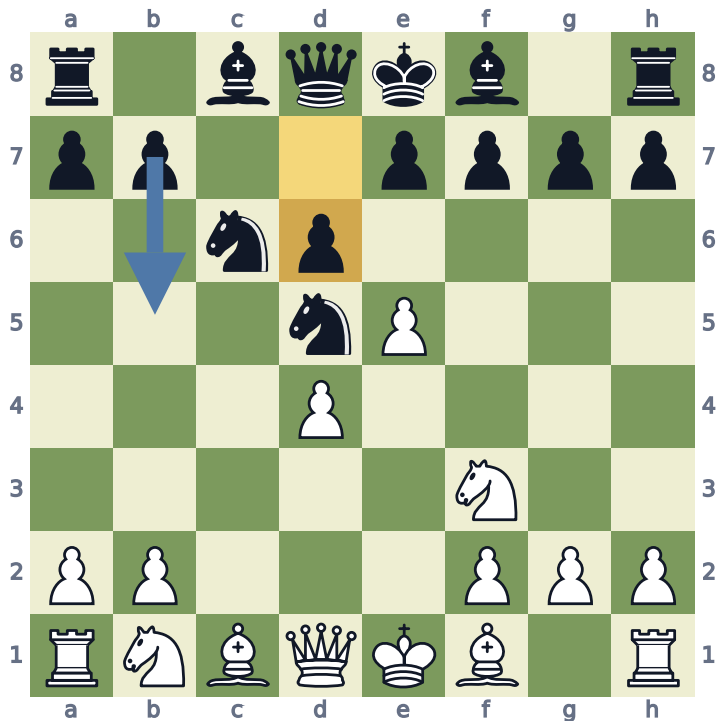
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White supports the broad center and uses development to keep the advanced e-pawn safe.

MEMORY RULE | When White builds a center, attack its front and base while developing.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

Black attacks e4 before White builds d4, forcing e5 and gaining targets on d4 and the advanced pawn chain.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Pressure e5 and d4, develop with tempo, and use ...d6 to undermine the chain.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White supports the broad center and uses development to keep the advanced e-pawn safe.

FAILURE MODE

Moving the knight repeatedly without completing development or challenging the center.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Can Black attack the pawn chain without allowing a tactic on the exposed d5 knight? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

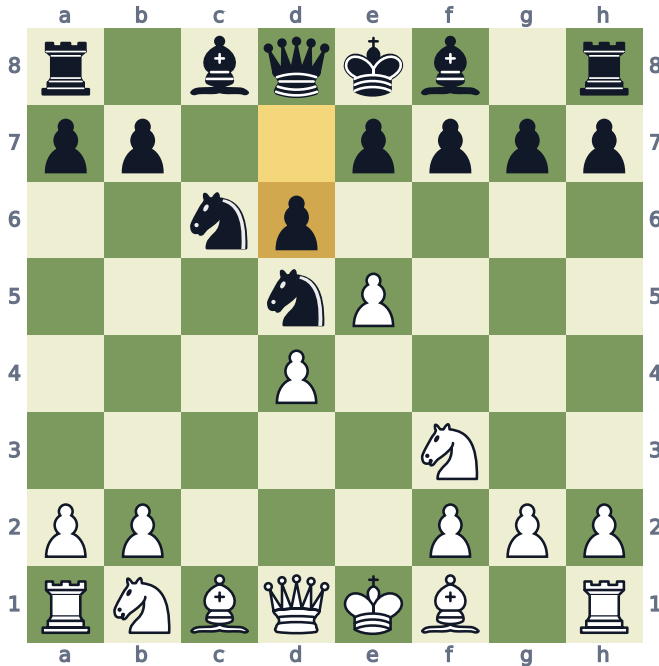
RULE | When White builds a center, attack its front and base while developing.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. c3 Nf6 3. e5 Nd5 4. d4 cxd4 5. Nf3 Nc6 6. cxd4 d6



- d4: White builds the Open Sicilian center and offers the d-pawn for rapid development.
- cxd4: Black releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Nf3: White reroutes a knight to f3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- cxd4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- d6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

Black attacks e4 before White builds d4, forcing e5 and gaining targets on d4 and the advanced pawn chain.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Can Black attack the pawn chain without allowing a tactic on the exposed d5 knight? White's resistance is: White supports the broad center and uses development to keep the advanced e-pawn safe. The line fails as a template when: Moving the knight repeatedly without completing development or challenging the center.

STORE THIS | When White builds a center, attack its front and base while developing.

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1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

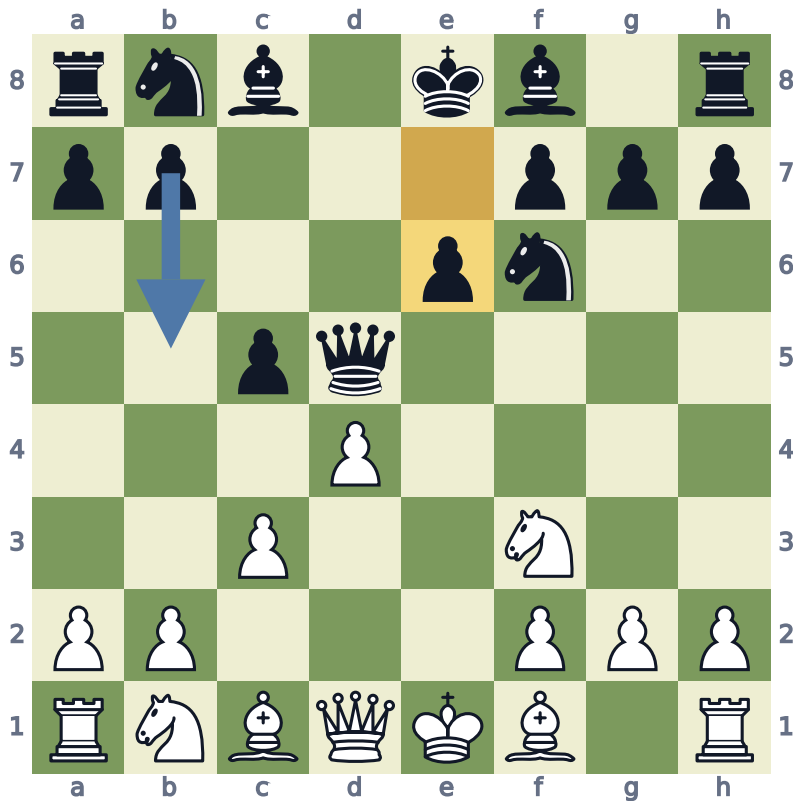
1. Black attacks e4 before White builds d4, forcing e5 and gaining targets on d4 and the advanced pawn chain. 2. Pressure e5 and d4, develop with tempo, and use ...d6 to undermine the chain. 3. White supports the broad center and uses development to keep the advanced e-pawn safe. 4. Can Black attack the pawn chain without allowing a tactic on the exposed d5 knight? 5. Moving the knight repeatedly without completing development or challenging the center.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 12 plies from memory, then replay: 4. d4 cxd4 5. Nf3 Nc6 6. cxd4 d6

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: 2...d5 immediate equality test



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...d5 challenges e4 immediately and often produces an isolated queen's pawn or symmetrical development battle.

DECISION RULE

Where can the queen stand so each white developing move does not attack it again?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Develop behind the active queen, pressure d4, and avoid unnecessary queen moves that donate tempi.

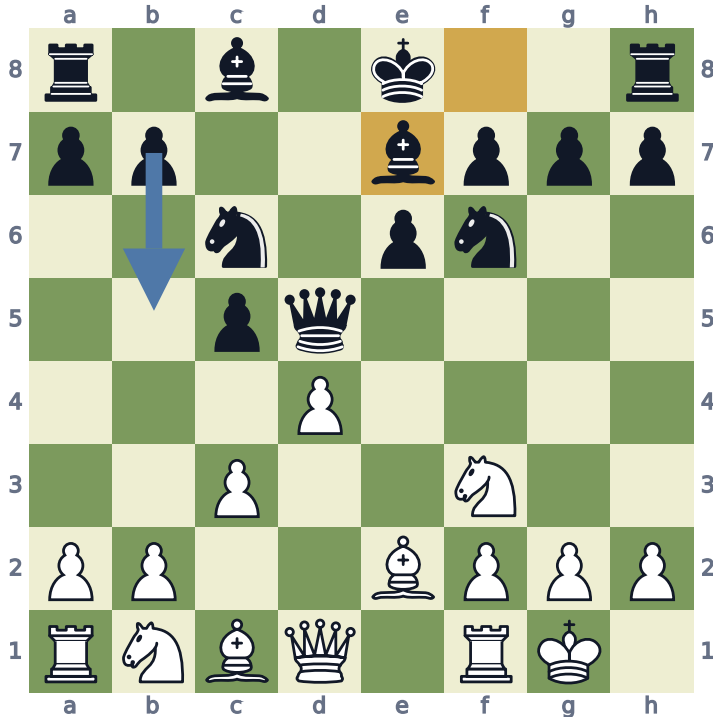
WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White gains time on the queen and tries to use the central space before exchanges simplify it.

MEMORY RULE | The central break works when the queen's recapture has a stable square.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...d5 challenges e4 immediately and often produces an isolated queen's pawn or symmetrical development battle.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Develop behind the active queen, pressure d4, and avoid unnecessary queen moves that donate tempi.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White gains time on the queen and tries to use the central space before exchanges simplify it.

FAILURE MODE

Winning central equality but losing two tempi to careless queen placement.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Where can the queen stand so each white developing move does not attack it again? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

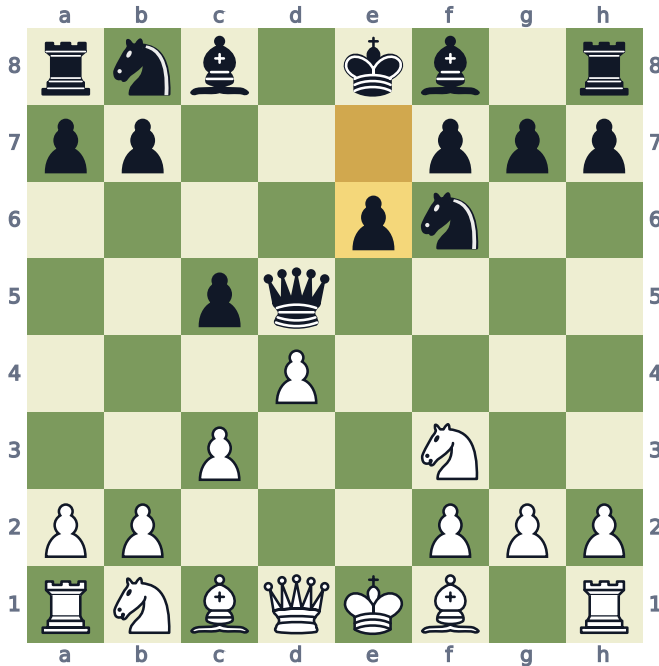
RULE | The central break works when the queen's recapture has a stable square.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. c3 d5 3. exd5 Qxd5 4. d4 Nf6 5. Nf3 e6 6. Be2 Nc6 7. O-O Be7



- exd5: White releases tension by capturing on d5; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Qxd5: Black releases tension by capturing on d5; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- d4: White builds the Open Sicilian center and offers the d-pawn for rapid development.
- Nf6: Black reroutes a knight to f6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Nf3: White reroutes a knight to f3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- e6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...d5 challenges e4 immediately and often produces an isolated queen's pawn or symmetrical development battle.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Where can the queen stand so each white developing move does not attack it again? White's resistance is: White gains time on the queen and tries to use the central space before exchanges simplify it. The line fails as a template when: Winning central equality but losing two tempi to careless queen placement.

STORE THIS | The central break works when the queen's recapture has a stable square.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

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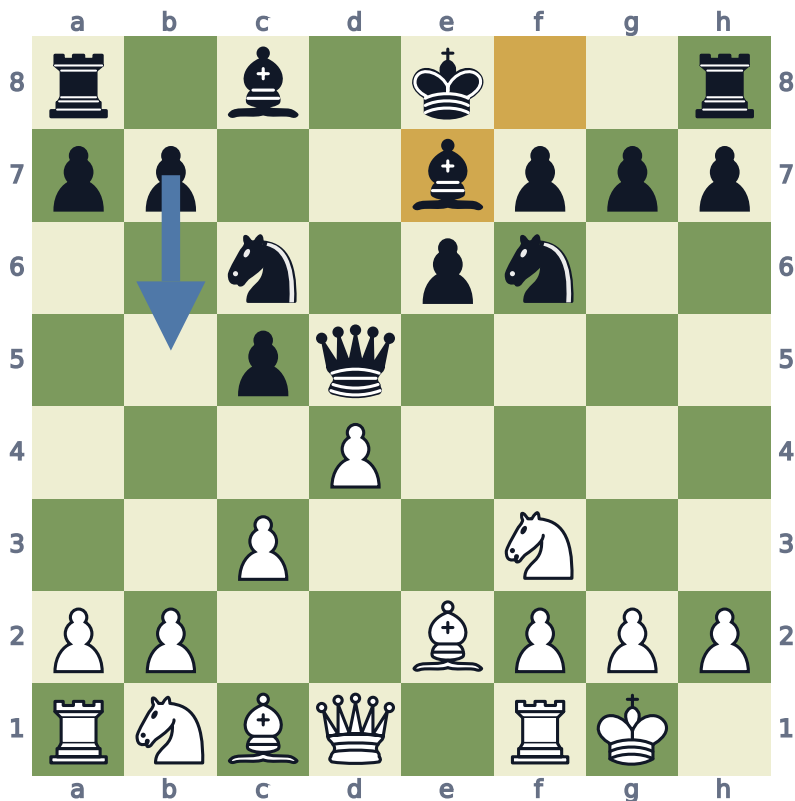
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 10 plies from memory, then replay: 3. exd5 Qxd5 4. d4 Nf6 5. Nf3 e6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: 2...d5 immediate equality test



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

...d5 challenges e4 immediately and often produces an isolated queen's pawn or symmetrical development battle.

DECISION RULE

Where can the queen stand so each white developing move does not attack it again?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Develop behind the active queen, pressure d4, and avoid unnecessary queen moves that donate tempi.

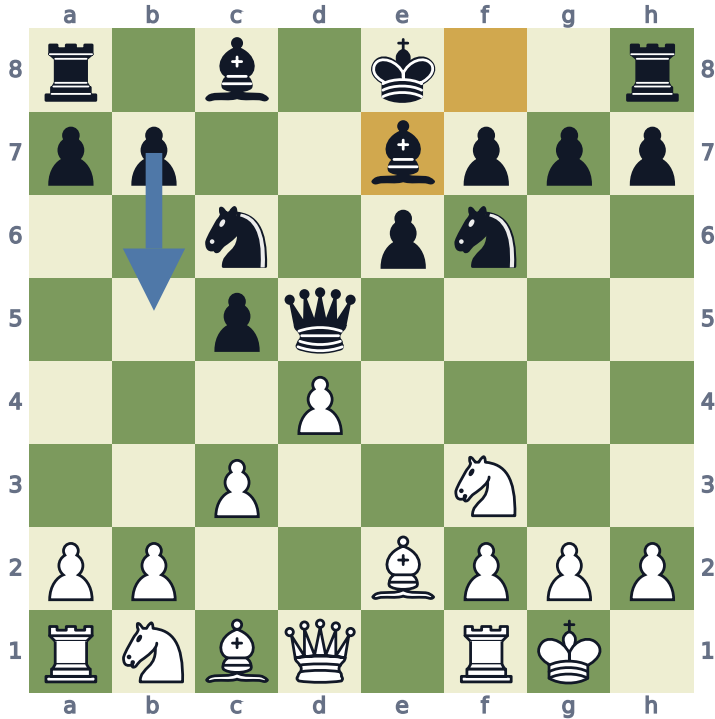
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White gains time on the queen and tries to use the central space before exchanges simplify it.

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CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

...d5 challenges e4 immediately and often produces an isolated queen's pawn or symmetrical development battle.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Develop behind the active queen, pressure d4, and avoid unnecessary queen moves that donate tempi.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White gains time on the queen and tries to use the central space before exchanges simplify it.

FAILURE MODE

Winning central equality but losing two tempi to careless queen placement.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Where can the queen stand so each white developing move does not attack it again? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

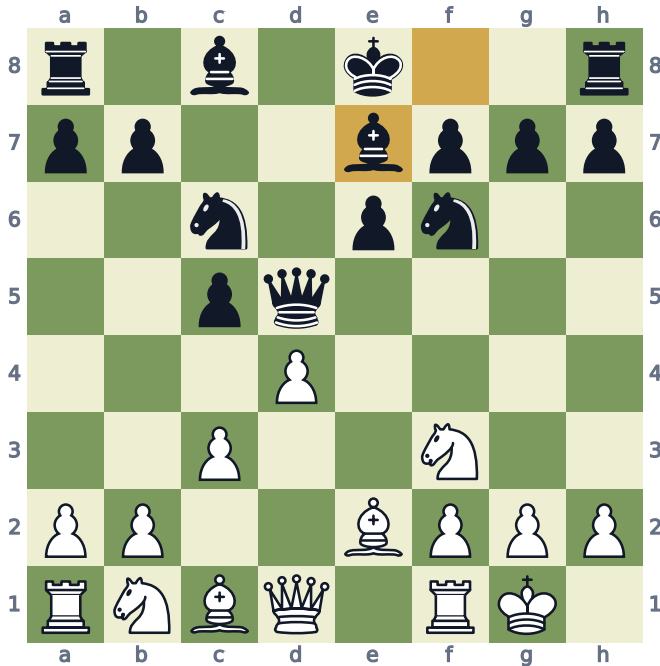
RULE | The central break works when the queen's recapture has a stable square.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. c3 d5 3. exd5 Qxd5 4. d4 Nf6 5. Nf3 e6 6. Be2 Nc6 7. O-O Be7



- Nf3: White reroutes a knight to f3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- e6: Black changes the pawn skeleton; reassess breaks, weak squares, open lines, and king exposure.
- Be2: White changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- O-O: White secures the king and connects a rook; central and wing operations can now be judged more concretely.
- Be7: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

...d5 challenges e4 immediately and often produces an isolated queen's pawn or symmetrical development battle.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Where can the queen stand so each white developing move does not attack it again? White's resistance is: White gains time on the queen and tries to use the central space before exchanges simplify it. The line fails as a template when: Winning central equality but losing two tempi to careless queen placement.

STORE THIS | The central break works when the queen's recapture has a stable square.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

2. What is Black's primary plan, and which piece or pawn enables it?

3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

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ANSWER KEY

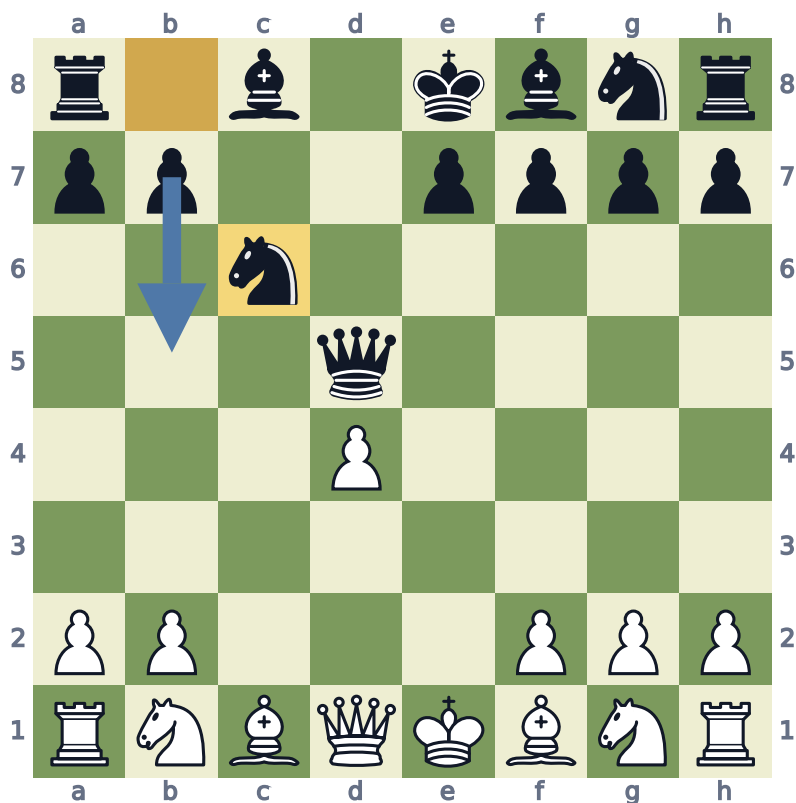
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BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. Nf3 e6 6. Be2 Nc6 7. O-O Be7

DECODE PASS | STRUCTURAL DECISION POINT

Decode: Isolated d-pawn transition

**WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS**

An isolated d-pawn grants White space and active lines but becomes a fixed endgame target if the initiative fades.

DECISION RULE

Can White play d5 with tactical force, and which piece is the best blockader if not?

SIDE TO MOVE

White

BLACK'S JOB

Blockade d5 or pressure d4, exchange active pieces selectively, and watch for White's d5 break.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White uses open files, rapid development, and d5 to convert the isolated pawn into activity.

MEMORY RULE | First stop the pawn's break; only then collect the weakness.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



CUE

An isolated d-pawn grants White space and active lines but becomes a fixed endgame target if the initiative fades.

BLACK AIMS FOR

Blockade d5 or pressure d4, exchange active pieces selectively, and watch for White's d5 break.

FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

White

WHITE'S BEST PRACTICAL IDEA

White uses open files, rapid development, and d5 to convert the isolated pawn into activity.

FAILURE MODE

Attacking the isolated pawn too early while White's pieces gain tempi against the king.

DECISION TEST

Ask: Can White play d5 with tactical force, and which piece is the best blockader if not? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

RULE | First stop the pawn's break; only then collect the weakness.

INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. c3 d5 3. exd5 Qxd5 4. d4 cxd4 5. cxd4 Nc6 6. Nf3 e5 7. Nc3 Bb4



- exd5: White releases tension by capturing on d5; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Qxd5: Black releases tension by capturing on d5; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- d4: White builds the Open Sicilian center and offers the d-pawn for rapid development.
- cxd4: Black releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- cxd4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

An isolated d-pawn grants White space and active lines but becomes a fixed endgame target if the initiative fades.

WHAT MUST BE CALCULATED

Can White play d5 with tactical force, and which piece is the best blockader if not? White's resistance is: White uses open files, rapid development, and d5 to convert the isolated pawn into activity. The line fails as a template when: Attacking the isolated pawn too early while White's pieces gain tempi against the king.

STORE THIS | First stop the pawn's break; only then collect the weakness.

COVER THE ANSWER KEY AND SPEAK EACH ANSWER

Retrieval and self-coaching

1. What center or structural transition defines this position?

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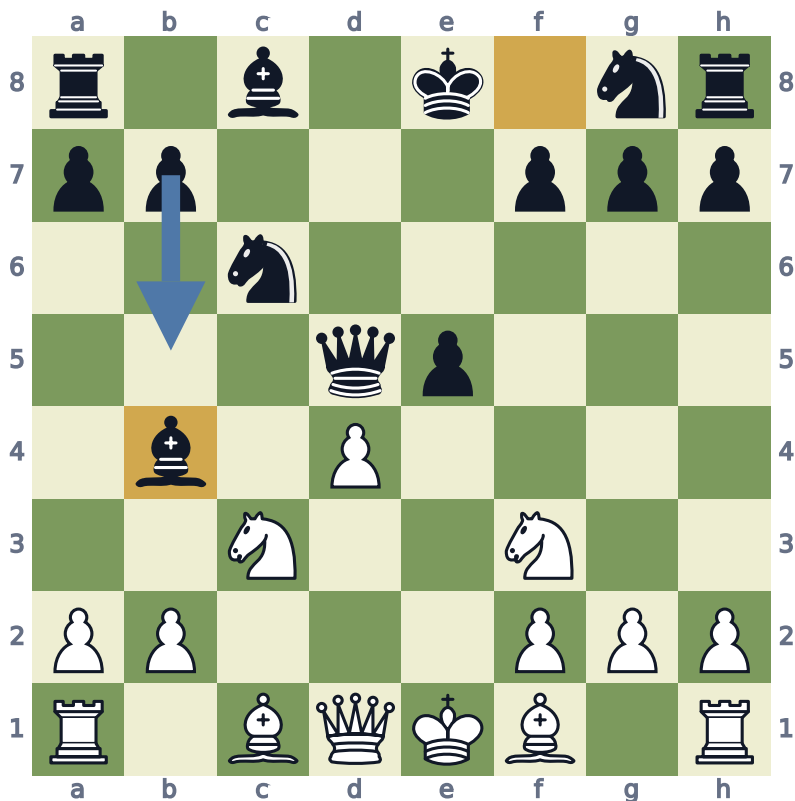
1. An isolated d-pawn grants White space and active lines but becomes a fixed endgame target if the initiative fades. 2. Blockade d5 or pressure d4, exchange active pieces selectively, and watch for White's d5 break. 3. White uses open files, rapid development, and d5 to convert the isolated pawn into activity. 4. Can White play d5 with tactical force, and which piece is the best blockader if not? 5. Attacking the isolated pawn too early while White's pieces gain tempi against the king.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 10 plies from memory, then replay: 3. exd5 Qxd5 4. d4 cxd4 5. cxd4 Nc6

PLAY PASS | PLAN EXECUTION AND TACTICAL CONTACT

Play: Isolated d-pawn transition



WHY THIS POSITION MATTERS

An isolated d-pawn grants White space and active lines but becomes a fixed endgame target if the initiative fades.

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SIDE TO MOVE

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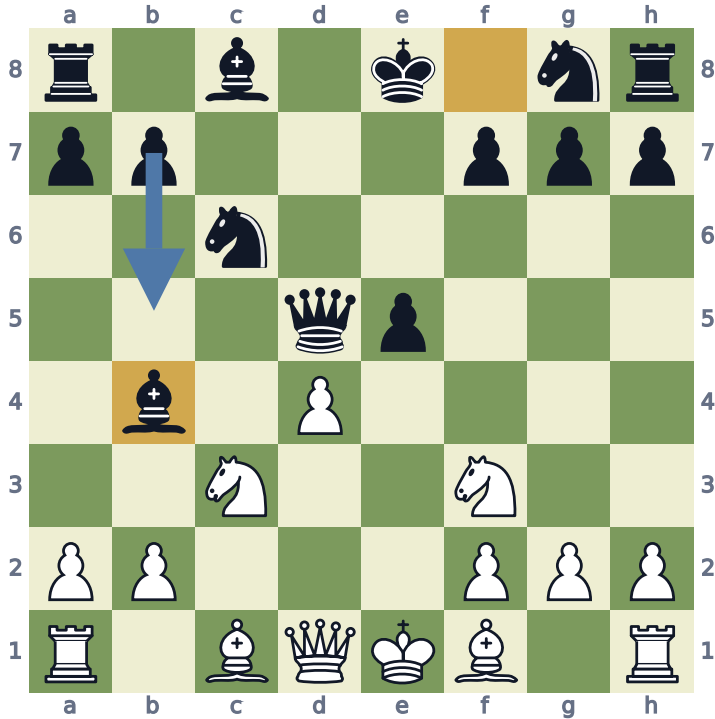
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White uses open files, rapid development, and d5 to convert the isolated pawn into activity.

MEMORY RULE | First stop the pawn's break; only then collect the weakness.

CUE -> REASON -> MOVE -> REPLY -> NEW POSITION

The plan map



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FINAL SIDE TO MOVE

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FAILURE MODE

Attacking the isolated pawn too early while White's pieces gain tempi against the king.

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Ask: Can White play d5 with tactical force, and which piece is the best blockader if not? Then compare at least two candidates against White's strongest forcing reply. Choose the endpoint whose center, king safety, and piece jobs you can explain.

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INSTRUCTIVE REFERENCE LINE - NOT A PROMISE OF FORCED BEST PLAY

Move-by-move meaning

REFERENCE LINE

1. e4 c5 2. c3 d5 3. exd5 Qxd5 4. d4 cxd4 5. cxd4 Nc6 6. Nf3 e5 7. Nc3 Bb4



- cxd4: White releases tension by capturing on d4; recalculate the pawn skeleton, open lines, and the opponent's most forcing recapture.
- Nc6: Black reroutes a knight to c6; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Nf3: White reroutes a knight to f3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- e5: Black gains central space and a knight tempo while accepting a lasting weakness on d5.
- Nc3: White reroutes a knight to c3; judge the move by the job at its destination and the time conceded on the way.
- Bb4: Black changes a bishop's diagonal; identify the central pawn move that will make that diagonal useful.

WHAT THE LINE TEACHES

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Can White play d5 with tactical force, and which piece is the best blockader if not? White's resistance is: White uses open files, rapid development, and d5 to convert the isolated pawn into activity. The line fails as a template when: Attacking the isolated pawn too early while White's pieces gain tempi against the king.

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3. What is White's fastest or most forcing counterplay?

4. What exact question decides the next move?

5. What is the most dangerous way to misuse the remembered plan?

ANSWER KEY

1. An isolated d-pawn grants White space and active lines but becomes a fixed endgame target if the initiative fades. 2. Blockade d5 or pressure d4, exchange active pieces selectively, and watch for White's d5 break. 3. White uses open files, rapid development, and d5 to convert the isolated pawn into activity. 4. Can White play d5 with tactical force, and which piece is the best blockader if not? 5. Attacking the isolated pawn too early while White's pieces gain tempi against the king.

BOARD RECONSTRUCTION

Rebuild the position after 14 plies from memory, then replay: 5. cxd4 Nc6 6. Nf3 e5 7. Nc3 Bb4

SIX-POSITION TEST

Can you retrieve the plan without the chapter?

LESSON 061 Decode: 2...Nf6 attacks e4

Prompt: Can Black attack the pawn chain without allowing a tactic on the exposed d5 knight?

Recall: When White builds a center, attack its front and base while developing.

LESSON 062 Play: 2...Nf6 attacks e4

Prompt: Can Black attack the pawn chain without allowing a tactic on the exposed d5 knight?

Recall: When White builds a center, attack its front and base while developing.

LESSON 063 Decode: 2...d5 immediate equality test

Prompt: Where can the queen stand so each white developing move does not attack it again?

Recall: The central break works when the queen's recapture has a stable square.

LESSON 064 Play: 2...d5 immediate equality test

Prompt: Where can the queen stand so each white developing move does not attack it again?

Recall: The central break works when the queen's recapture has a stable square.

LESSON 065 Decode: Isolated d-pawn transition

Prompt: Can White play d5 with tactical force, and which piece is the best blockader if not?

Recall: First stop the pawn's break; only then collect the weakness.

LESSON 066 Play: Isolated d-pawn transition

Prompt: Can White play d5 with tactical force, and which piece is the best blockader if not?

Recall: First stop the pawn's break; only then collect the weakness.

PASS STANDARD

For each position: name the structure, Black's plan, White's counterplay, one candidate, the strongest reply, and the failure mode. Score one point each; 30 of 36 is a pass.

THREE SCENARIOS TO STORE

One-page repertoire memory sheet

CARD 1

2...Nf6 attacks e4

1. e4 c5 2. c3 Nf6 3. e5 Nd5 4. d4 cxd4 5. Nf3 Nc6 6. cxd4 d6

Decision: Can Black attack the pawn chain without allowing a tactic on the exposed d5 knight?

Memory: When White builds a center, attack its front and base while developing.

CARD 2

2...d5 immediate equality test

1. e4 c5 2. c3 d5 3. exd5 Qxd5 4. d4 Nf6 5. Nf3 e6 6. Be2 Nc6 7. O-O Be7

Decision: Where can the queen stand so each white developing move does not attack it again?

Memory: The central break works when the queen's recapture has a stable square.

CARD 3

Isolated d-pawn transition

1. e4 c5 2. c3 d5 3. exd5 Qxd5 4. d4 cxd4 5. cxd4 Nc6 6. Nf3 e5 7. Nc3 Bb4

Decision: Can White play d5 with tactical force, and which piece is the best blockader if not?

Memory: First stop the pawn's break; only then collect the weakness.

Reconstruct each card from the final position, then from the opening moves alone.

SPACED RETRIEVAL AND GAME TRANSFER

Volume mastery tracker

Lesson	D1	D3	D7	D14	D30	Game	Pass
061 Decode: 2...Nf6 attacks e4	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
062 Play: 2...Nf6 attacks e4	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
063 Decode: 2...d5 immediate equality test	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
064 Play: 2...d5 immediate equality test	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
065 Decode: Isolated d-pawn transition	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
066 Play: Isolated d-pawn transition	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

TWELVE-WEEK CYCLE

Weeks 1-2: decode the three structures. Weeks 3-4: replay all lines from memory. Weeks 5-7: solve the workbook pages. Weeks 8-10: test in slow games or against Fritz. Weeks 11-12: analyze failures and retest the volume examination.

PROMOTION RULE

Advance only when you can explain every memory rule, reproduce the three reference lines, name White's best counterplay, and show at least one analyzed game where the decision appeared.

Do not measure mastery by pages completed. Measure whether the correct questions appear during a real game.